

project.org

STUDENT HANDOUT

GREEN LEVEL
MORE SUPPORT

Migration by Numbers

Grades 5–8 · Math

ADMIT ONE

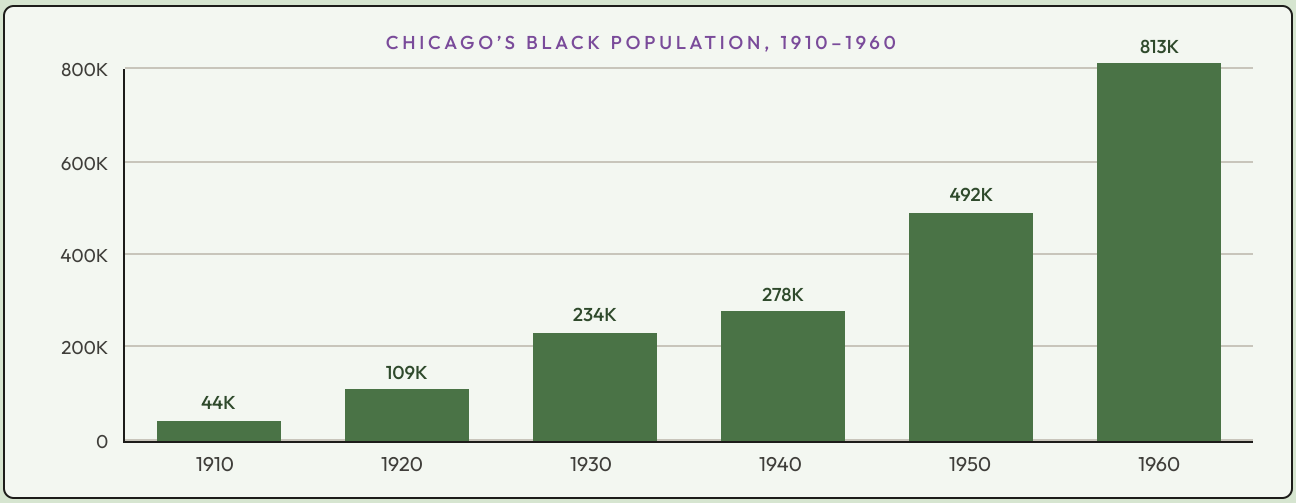
NAME _____ DATE _____ CLASS _____

Big idea: During the Great Migration, millions of Black Americans moved from the South to Northern cities. We can use **data** to see how quickly cities like Chicago changed. A **percentage change** tells us how much something grew compared to where it started.

Formula: (New − Old) ÷ Old × 100

PART 1

01 Read the bar chart



1. In which decade did the population grow the most? Circle:

1910–20 | 1920–30 | 1930–40 | 1940–50 | 1950–60

2. Approximately how many more people lived in Chicago in 1960 than in 1910?

02

PART 2

Calculate one percentage change

Use the formula: **(New − Old) ÷ Old × 100**

Chicago's Black population in 1910: **44,103** In 1920: **109,458**

Step 1 — Subtract: 109,458 − 44,103 = _____

Step 2 — Divide: _____ ÷ 44,103 = _____

Step 3 — Multiply by 100: _____ × 100 = _____ %

03

PART 3

Interpret the data

3. Why do you think Chicago's Black population grew so fast between 1910 and 1920?

4. The population grew by over 148% in one decade. What does that mean in plain English?

5. Numbers can tell us how many people moved. What can't numbers tell us about the Great Migration?

MINI MUSEUM CONNECTION

The Great Migration Map in the exhibition shows the route from the Mississippi Delta to Harlem. The journey was about 1,500 miles. Each dot on the map represents tens of thousands of real people making that journey.

minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/harlem-renaissance

SHARE WITH YOUR FAMILY

Tell someone at home: *"Chicago's Black population grew by 148% in just 10 years."* Ask them: what does that kind of growth do to a city?